

SHOWTIME

CLASSROOM GAMESHOWS

Teacher guide - version 1.2

Four revision games for the front of the classroom, inspired by classic TV quiz formats. They share one question bank and run from a single file, with no internet connection, logins or installs.



What's in Showtime

Over the Edge - 2 to 6 teams

Every team that answers right wins a counter to drop down a lane onto a moving shelf. Counters pushed over the front edge win £100. In the final, the whole class plays together to push the gold jackpot counter over the edge for £5,000.

Outpace - 2 to 6 teams, one runner

The whole class is one runner. Vote for a deal, then answer your way home before the Hunter catches you. One Deal Round, then a 60-second Final Sprint against a target set by the pot.

Category Clash - 2 to 6 teams

A board of four categories and points values from 100 to 300. Teams take turns to choose and every team answers; harder questions are worth more, and one hidden ★ tile is worth double.

Hex Hunt - two halves of the class

A board of lettered hexagons. Each letter is the first letter of the answer. Win a hexagon to claim it and pick the next; the first half to link its two edges wins.

- **Everyone answers every question** on mini whiteboards (or paper). No pupil devices are needed. Two teams work just as well for a pair or a tutoring session.
- **One shared question bank.** Choose your subject and question set once on the menu and every game uses it. Add your own sets by pasting plain text.
- **Built-in packs, one per specification topic.** AQA- and Edexcel-style GCSE sciences, Maths, History and Geography: every topic and option (7,700+ questions), each tied to a specification point. Not endorsed by AQA or Pearson.
- **Weak topics come round again.** Wrong answers are saved against each team's name, and questions from topics a team got wrong before come up a little more often in every game.
- **A friendly host.** A cartoon host presents Over the Edge, greets you on the menu and adds short captions in the other games. He has no name until you give him one: use **Customise the host** on the menu to name him (your own name works well) and restyle him. Clear the name to make him nameless again.

Getting started

1. Save **showtime-classroom-gameshows.html** somewhere on your computer, such as your Documents folder or a memory stick. Keep the same copy each lesson, because your question sets are saved for that browser.
2. Double-click it. It opens in your web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari). No internet connection is needed. Press **Full screen** (or **F**) to fill the board; **Esc** leaves full screen.
3. **Choose your subject** from the dropdown on the left of the menu, and your exam board. Then open **Questions** and tick the topic (or topics) you are teaching, or **Mixed: all topics**. Untick **Include Higher tier only questions** for a Foundation class. Showtime remembers it all next time.
4. Choose a game. Its setup card asks only for the **number of teams**. **Edit team names** opens the names (they carry over to every game); the card also shows the questions in use, with **Change** to go back to the menu. Press **Start** or **Enter**. The game screen then waits on a big **Start game** button with nothing ticking, so you can explain the rules and hand out whiteboards; the first countdown starts when you press it (or **Enter**).

Running it with a class

Split about 30 students into 2 to 6 teams with mini whiteboards. Every game works the same way:

The loop for every question

1. The question appears with a **20-second countdown** (Maths: the **Answer time** on the setup card, 45 sec, 1 min 30 or 2 min). Everyone writes an answer.
2. When time is up, or you press **[Space]**, "**3, 2, 1, show me!**" appears and boards go up.
3. Mark each team: tap its panel or press its number **[1-6]** to toggle ✓/✗, or **[C]** for all correct, **[W]** for all wrong. **[Enter]** confirms. Six teams take a few seconds.
4. The answer appears for the whole class, and each correct team's panel shows what it earned.
5. Made a slip? **[U]** undoes the marking until the next question starts (in Over the Edge, until the first counter drops).

Team rule (shown on the setup card): a team is correct only if its whiteboards agree on a correct answer, or if you judge it correct. It gets teams explaining answers to each other, which is the point.

Captains rotate. When a team makes a choice (a lane, a tile, a hexagon), the screen names the team and says *Captain: swap to the next person*, so everyone gets a turn at the exciting part.

10 minutes at most each, with time for teams to think, talk and write. Over the Edge: 6 questions then a 4-question final. Outpace: one Deal Round and the Final Sprint. Category Clash: 4 categories of 3 questions. Hex Hunt: one round on a 4 × 4 board. Each is tuned to be close, and the class wins the jackpot or the sprint about half the time. Press **End game** (Category Clash) or **◀ Menu** to stop early. With Maths each question has its longer answer time, so allow about a minute more per question at 1 min 30 (Over the Edge and Category Clash about 20 minutes; Outpace's Final Sprint lasts longer to match); press **[Space]** as soon as every board is ready.

Reteach these

Every game ends with the questions most teams got wrong, with the answers and topics, so you know what to go over next lesson. It never records anything about individual students.

Over the Edge

Every correct team wins a counter. The correct teams **take turns to drop**, in a random order shown on screen. Each captain picks a lane (**[1-4]**), tap the machine, or **[R]** for random lanes for the rest); the counter drops, the shelf finishes its push, and **whatever comes over the edge during that team's drop is theirs** (its £100 label flashes in that team's colour). Then the next team drops. Six teams take about eight seconds. Watch for **★ wildcard counters**: a bonus drop, £250, or a steal from the leading team. In the final the whole class plays together for the jackpot, two counters per correct team; a team with no more than half the leader's money drops a catch-up counter as the final starts.

Outpace

The class votes on the deal by holding up 1, 2 or 3 fingers and you press the majority: **Cautious** (300 points, Hunter 5 steps back), **Standard** (600, 3 back) or **Bold** (1,000, 1 back). If **at least half the teams** are correct the runner steps forward; otherwise the Hunter gains ("4 of 6 teams correct"). Reach home to bank the deal; if caught, bank half. In the 60-second **Final Sprint** every correct team is one step towards the target, and the class escapes as soon as it gets there. The racers change with the subject (atoms for science, maths symbols, books, hourglasses, globes); the class is always the gold one and the Hunter the magenta one. The gap meter under the deal shows how far ahead of the Hunter the class is and how far it is to home; the sprint has a clock in the set that turns red for the last ten seconds.

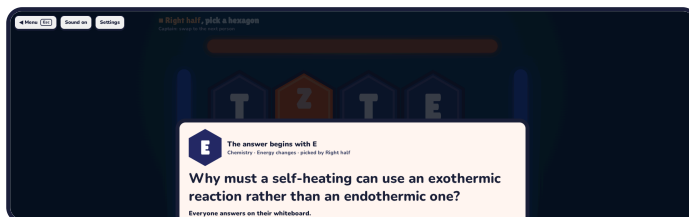
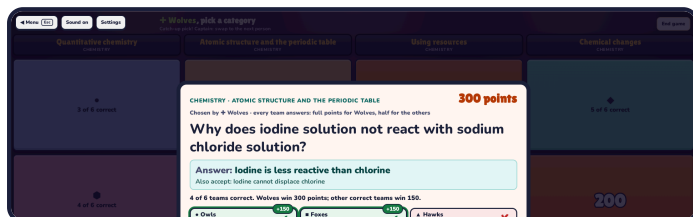
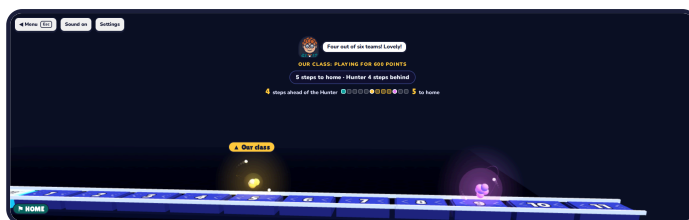
Category Clash

The columns are the topics you ticked on the menu (open **Topics** on the setup screen to choose up to four, or leave it to pick a different mix each game). With just one topic ticked, the columns are that topic's subtopics from the specification, so a one-topic lesson still has a full board. The rows follow difficulty: 100 is recall, 200 describe and apply, 300 explain and extend. The choosing team picks a tile; every team answers. The choosing team wins full points if correct, every other correct team wins half, and wrong answers lose nothing. The **★** tile doubles everything. Each team chooses once per round; a team at least 300 points behind gets the first pick of the next round.

Hex Hunt

Each half can be several table groups. Team 1 links left to right, Team 2 top to bottom. After "show me", compare the whiteboards and press the half that had more right answers (**[1]** or **[2]**, or tap its big button). It wins the hexagon and picks next. If it's level, press the half that chose the hexagon; if nobody got it, press **Neither** (**[N]**). **[U]** undoes it. Each letter is the first letter of the answer (ignoring "the", "a" or "an"); answers that are explanations, lists or numbers never go on the board. The gold outline is the keyboard cursor: it appears when you use the arrow keys.

In play



Keyboard shortcuts

Everything also works by mouse or touch. Keys are shown on the buttons. **Enter** starts or replays from the setup and results screens, and **Esc** returns to the menu (you are asked first mid-game).

Every game	Each game
Space Skip the countdown: "3, 2, 1, show me!" (again to skip the 3, 2, 1)	1-4 / R Over the Edge: that lane / random lanes for the rest
1-6 Mark that team ✓ or ✗	1 2 3 Outpace: Cautious, Standard or Bold deal
C / W Every team correct / every team wrong	← → ↑ ↓ Category Clash and Hex Hunt: move around the board and pick
Enter Confirm the marking, then carry on	Enter
U Undo the marking	1 / 2 / N Hex Hunt: the half with more right answers, or Neither
Enter / Space Start game after setup; skip a big moment (a catch, an escape, the ★ tile, a winning chain)	
F Full screen on or off (Esc also leaves it)	

Classroom tips

- **Seat teams together** with one whiteboard per pupil, or one per pair. Five or six in a team works well.
- **Use "Any two" answers generously.** Many answers list several acceptable points. You are the judge, so accept good alternatives.
- **Need more thinking time?** Let the countdown run out, or wait before pressing **Space**: the "show me" only comes when you are ready.
- **Revisit weak topics.** Use **Reteach these** on the results screen to plan a starter for next lesson.

Adding your own questions

Open **Question bank** on the menu. Type a name for the set, check its **Subject** (it starts as the subject chosen on the menu), paste your questions in this format, and press **Save as new set**:

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Bonding

Q: What type of bonding is in sodium chloride?

A: Ionic

Q: Why can metals conduct electricity?

A: They have delocalised electrons that can move through the structure

Topic: Rates of reaction

Q: Give two ways to increase the rate of a reaction.

A: Any two: increase temperature, increase concentration, increase surface area, add a catalyst

- The **Subject** and **Topic** lines apply to every question below them until the next one. Topics drive the weak-topic tracking, so keep topic names consistent between sets.
- Every **Q:** line needs an **A:** line straight after it. Blank lines are ignored. Question sets from earlier versions of these games use the same format and paste straight in.

- Optional, after an **A:** line: **Accept:** other answers to accept, separated by **;**, and **Note:** a note for you (a common mistake, say). Both appear with the answer in every game.
- Optional: a line such as **Difficulty: 2** applies to the questions below it. Tag a question by the most demanding thing it asks: **1, Recall** (one fact, name or term: Name, State, Which...?); **2, Describe and apply** (a definition, a process or test and its result, an equation to recall, several facts, or a one-step use of a rule); **3, Explain and extend** (a reason, a comparison, a calculation where the equation isn't given, or a new context). Category Clash puts difficulty 1 on the 100 row, 2 on the 200 row and 3 on the 300 row, borrowing the nearest if a topic runs short. Without the line, it reads a difficulty from the question's wording. A **Tier: Higher** line marks Higher-tier-only questions (left out when you untick them on the menu). Sets from earlier versions still work: their **Tier: 1–3** lines are read as difficulty.
- A new set is ticked for every game straight away. Change what is ticked from **Questions** on the menu, or with the tick boxes in the Question bank, which also shows each built-in pack's specification code and version.
- The Question bank lists the sets for the chosen subject. Move one of your sets to another subject with its **Subject** list. Sets made before version 1.4 have no subject, so they show under every subject until you give them one; sets you filed under Combined Science or English before version 1.1 show under **Other**.
- Rename, Edit questions** or **Delete** your own sets from the list. Deleting asks you to tap twice.
- The built-in packs cannot be changed, but **Copy to edit** makes your own copy that you can trim or add to.



Moving to another computer: backups

Press **Save backup file** to download one file containing all your own sets and every team's wrong-answer history. On the other computer, open Showtime, choose **Question bank** → **Load backup file** and pick that file. Loading a backup only adds; it never deletes anything already there, and loading the same file twice adds nothing new.

Teams' wrong answers

History is saved by team name, so use the same spelling each time (capital letters do not matter). The question bank lists every saved team; **Clear** removes one team's history.

Settings and accessibility

Setting	What it does
Sound	All sounds are short effects made by the browser. There is no music.
Text size	Large makes every panel, question and button bigger for the back of the room.
Reduced motion	Stops camera moves, sway, screen shake, slow motion, confetti, tile flips and spins and the flash when the Hunter catches someone; the big moments become simple changes, and the host's words show at once. It starts switched on if your computer asks for reduced motion.
Graphics	Low turns off shadows, glow, light beams and the heavier effects and draws at standard resolution, for older PCs. Outpace also steps its own quality down if a computer can't keep up.

Colours meet the WCAG AA contrast guidelines. Nothing relies on colour alone: teams are also marked ●■▲◆●+ (Team 1 is always blue ●, Team 2 orange ■, Team 3 purple ▲, Team 4 teal ◆, Team 5 pink ●, Team 6 green +), wildcard counters carry a ★, the Hunter and the runner are labelled, and buttons show ✓ and ✗ as well as green and red.

Privacy and data protection

No data leaves the computer. Showtime makes no network connections at all: no analytics, no tracking, no accounts and no adverts. It even includes a browser security rule that blocks connections.

Question sets, team names, wrong-answer history, the host's look and your settings are saved only in the web browser on the computer you are using (in its local storage). They are not sent to us or anyone else.

For UK GDPR, this means the school stays in control: data stays on the school's device, you can delete a team's history at any time from the question bank, and a backup file is only created when you choose to save one. If you use pupils' names, treat backup files like any other file containing pupil data. You can also use first names, initials or team names instead.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
The file opens as text, or in a preview pane	Download or copy it to your computer first, then double-click it. Previews in email, Teams or OneDrive cannot run it.
"3D graphics are switched off"	Try another browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari). If it still appears, ask IT to turn on hardware acceleration in the browser settings.
The game is jerky or slow	Set Graphics to Low . Close other tabs and video calls.
No sound	Check Sound is on, the board's speakers are on, and the volume is up. Browsers only play sound after the first click or key press.
My question sets have gone	Sets are saved in one browser on one computer. Open the same file in the same browser you used before. Private or guest windows forget everything when closed, and some school setups clear browser data at log-off: keep a backup file and load it when needed.
"This browser is blocking storage" message	The games still work, but nothing is kept after you close the page. Use a normal (not private) window, or keep a backup file.
"No Maths questions yet" and Start is greyed out	That subject has no built-in pack yet. Add your own set in the Question bank, or press Change and choose another subject.
"No Q: and A: pairs found"	Check each question line starts with Q: and is followed by a line starting with A: .
Text is hard to read from the back	Turn on Large text size and use Full screen (F).
I pressed a key and nothing happened	Click once on the game area first, so the browser knows the keys are for the game. Keys are ignored while you type in a box.

About

Showtime: Classroom Gameshows, version 1.2.1. Game design and question packs by Rob Pearce. The games are original works inspired by classic TV quiz formats and are not connected with any television programme or broadcaster. AQA is a registered trade mark of AQA Education and Edexcel of Pearson Education; the built-in packs are AQA-style and Edexcel-style practice questions written for Showtime and are not endorsed by AQA or Pearson.

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